

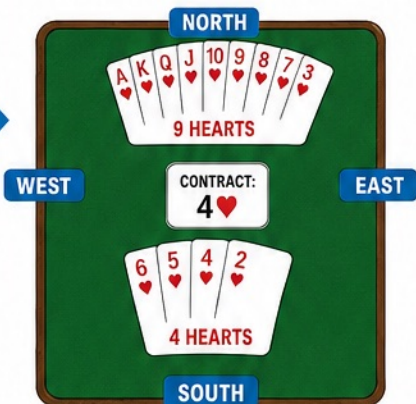
Lesson 05: Playing with Trumps

1 THE FIT

8+ cards in one suit between the 2 hands → that suit becomes **TRUMP**

EXAMPLE

9 hearts (North)
+ 4 hearts (South)
= 13 hearts
→ **HEARTS**
become **TRUMP**



2 PRIORITY



Spades / Hearts (major)
> No Trump > Clubs / Diamonds (minor)

3 THE 3 POWERS OF TRUMPS



1. CONTROL

Ruff opponents' winners



Ruff the King of Spades with the **Ace of Hearts**.



2. LENGTHENING

Gain more tricks by ruffing from the short hand



South is **short** in Diamonds. Ruffing in the short hand preserves trumps in the **long** hand (North) to take more tricks.



3. ESTABLISHING

Ruff to establish a long suit



Ruff in **hearts**, then lead hearts from North to establish a long heart suit.

4 DRAWING TRUMPS



Remove opponents' trumps before cashing long suits.

Why?

So your long suits won't be ruffed by the opponents.

Draw trumps first

Then cash your long suits



5 REEVALUATION

For a single hand, **NEVER** on the total fit.

With fit, add distribution points of the **RESPONDER**:

K	7	Doubleton	+1
K		Singleton	+3
		Void	+5

MAX 5 EXTRA POINTS

6 VISUAL EXAMPLE OF A RUFF

When a player has 0 cards in the suit, they ruff with a trump.



South has no clubs. They ruff the trick with the **Ace of Hearts**.